Beyond the 100-year line

One app. Two sides. One flood story.

A flood map for decision-makers that also tells residents what they need, when they need it.

THE PROBLEM

39

people died in the July 2021 floods in Wallonia

~48,000

buildings damaged, 45,000 of them homes

1-in-100

years: the planning line. On the Vesdre, 2021 went far beyond it

Sources: Walloon Government press release, 4 July 2022 (deaths, buildings); Wallonia 'Annexe F' GEV analysis of river gauges, Oct 2021 (Vesdre).

And in a crisis, people forget the basics, and don't know where to look for the one thing that matters right now: can I use the water, the electricity, the gas? (a point raised by a local mayor)

THE IDEA: ONE APP, TWO SIDES

Policy makers

See the risk. Act on it.

- Map: where July 2021 really flooded vs the official 1-in-100-year flood zone
- Which municipalities have the most buildings in flood zones (tap to see)
- A 4-step story for briefings
- Send a verified message to residents
- Set water / electricity / gas status per municipality

Residents

Know what to do. Right now.

- Opens on 5 big, simple essentials (112, evacuate, cut gas...), every time
- Flood zones near you, and where it flooded in 2021
- Water / electricity / gas: green, amber or red for your municipality
- Notifications from the authorities on your phone
- Links to BE-Alert and the Crisis Centre

HOW A MESSAGE TRAVELS

Policy maker
writes a message or sets a status

→

Verified
a code checks who is sending

→

Residents' phones
get a notification within seconds

How to talk about it

THE 30-SECOND PITCH

"In July 2021, the water went where the official 1-in-100-year maps did not expect it. Our app shows decision-makers exactly that gap, municipality by municipality. And it gives residents one place for what matters in a crisis: the essentials, the flood zones near them, and a simple green, amber or red for water, electricity and gas, set by their authorities and pushed to their phone."

WHY PEOPLE CAN TRUST IT

- It never invents safety information: tiles stay grey ("No information yet") until an authority sets them, and there are no made-up shelter pins.
- Advice comes from the National Crisis Centre, in plain language, with the source shown.
- Every number on the map has a source; the key figure was computed twice with two independent methods (156 vs 158 buildings: they agree).
- Maps work offline; only the background map needs internet.

WORDS TO USE / AVOID

Use

- "1-in-100-year flood zone"
- "how rare a flood is"
- "at least ... buildings" (counts are a minimum)
- "set by your authorities"

Avoid

- "predict" floods (return periods are not forecasts)
- "safe" (only authorities can say that)
- "real-time alerts" (it's a demo)
- exact counts without "at least"

PROTOTYPE: WHAT'S REAL, WHAT'S DEMO

Real

- Flood analysis on the official challenge data
- Android app + web page
- Phone notifications

Demo (say so on stage)

- Messages pass through a laptop, not a real server
- A shared code stands in for real ID (eID / itsme)
- In reality, alerts go through BE-Alert

Still open for the team

Which named public actor we address (e.g. the Walloon Government / SPW or the municipalities), our recommendation, and the 3 key numbers on the app's front panel.